



Your business, seen properly.

Product Requirements Document

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Status In Review	Platform Mobile-first Web	Market Nigeria (Global)	Target launch Q3 2026
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1. Executive summary

Kova is a mobile-first client experience platform built for small and micro businesses across Nigeria and, eventually, the world. It enables any business owner — a hairdresser, a plumber, a caterer, a lawyer — to send every client a beautifully branded, professional invoice and job summary page in under 30 seconds, directly through WhatsApp.

The platform is designed around three non-negotiable principles for the Nigerian market: zero new habit required, lightweight enough to run on 3G, and visible results from the very first use. Clients receive a premium experience. Business owners build a professional reputation effortlessly. And every invoice sent becomes a quiet advertisement that spreads Kova organically.

North star: What if every small business owner could make every client touchpoint feel like they hired a top-tier agency — without hiring anyone?

A tool that helps you get paid faster and look professional doing it

2. Problem statement

2.1 The perception gap

Small business owners in Nigeria are skilled, hardworking, and deeply trusted within their communities. But the tools they use to communicate with clients — WhatsApp voice notes, handwritten receipts, PDF screenshots, verbal confirmations — make them look informal, even when the quality of their work is exceptional.

This is not a visibility problem. It is a perception problem. The gap between how good these businesses actually are and how professional they appear to clients costs them repeat business, referrals, and the ability to charge what they are worth.

2.2 Why existing tools fail

- Website builders (Wix, Squarespace) require too much setup, ongoing maintenance, and design skill
- Invoicing apps (Wave, QuickBooks) are desktop-heavy, slow, and not WhatsApp-native
- Social media profiles are passive — they do not create direct client touchpoints after a job
- Generic PDF invoices carry no brand identity and feel impersonal
- Most tools require a learning curve that Nigerian SMB owners simply do not have time for

2.3 Key data points

Insight	Source / Context
40% of small businesses have no website in 2025	Global SMB digital presence study, 2025
70–80% of consumers research a business online before visiting	Consumer behaviour research, 2025
85% of consumers trust online reviews as much as personal recommendations	Mindstream Media Group study
Businesses using branded digital proposals dramatically outperform those sending PDFs	ClientPoint, 2025
Platform fatigue and fragmented tools erode client trust	ClientPoint From Tools to Trust, 2025
2/3 of SMB owners say AI has impacted their business — but mostly in operations, not client experience	SMB Group Survey, 2025

3. Product vision and goals

3.1 Vision

Vision: To become the default client experience layer for small businesses across Africa and emerging markets — the tool that makes every business owner look like a premium brand, and every client feel genuinely valued.

3.2 Strategic goals

- **Goal 1:** Enable any small business owner to set up a fully branded profile in under 5 minutes
- **Goal 2:** Allow any job summary and invoice to be sent to a client in under 30 seconds
- **Goal 3:** Ensure the platform works reliably on 3G connections and low-spec Android devices
- **Goal 4:** Create a self-spreading product where every client touchpoint promotes Kova organically
- **Goal 5:** Build compounding retention through data, payment history, and reputation that accumulates over time

3.3 Success metrics — MVP

Metric	Target	Timeframe	Signal
Business sign-ups	500 active businesses	Month 3	Market acceptance
Invoices sent per business per month	12+	Month 2	Daily habit formed
Client page open rate	>70%	Ongoing	Client engagement
Payment via Kova link	>40% of invoices	Month 3	Core value delivered
D30 retention (business owners)	>60%	Month 3	Stickiness
Organic referrals from clients	>25% of new sign-ups	Month 4	Viral flywheel working

Shift focus from usage → revenue impact:

- % of invoices paid
- Average revenue per user
- Weekly active businesses
- Repeat invoice rate
- Reviews per business

3.4 Moat & Defensibility Strategy

Kova's long-term advantage is built on a combination of **data, reputation, network effects, and behavioral integration**.

As businesses use Kova, they accumulate **invoice history, client records, earnings data, and reviews**, making Kova their primary system of record. This creates strong **data lock-in**, as leaving the platform results in loss of business continuity and social proof.

Kova also establishes a **transaction-backed reputation layer**, where every review is tied to a real job. This builds a trusted profile that increases a business's ability to win clients and charge premium rates.

Each invoice sent introduces new clients to Kova, creating **organic network effects** where professional, structured transactions become expected. Over time, this drives adoption through client-side demand.

Additionally, Kova integrates directly into existing workflows via WhatsApp, creating **behavioral lock-in** by aligning with how businesses already operate.

As data compounds, Kova can evolve into a **financial identity layer**, enabling access to insights, credit, and growth opportunities — positioning the platform as critical infrastructure for small businesses

4. Target users

4.1 Primary user — the business owner

Any individual or micro-business providing a service or product to clients in Nigeria. They are mobile-first, WhatsApp-native, and time-poor. They want to look professional but have no time or budget to hire designers or manage complex software.

User personas

Persona	Description
Kemi — salon owner, Lagos	Runs a 2-chair beauty studio. Sends receipts on WhatsApp. Wants clients to see her as a premium salon, not a side hustle. Checks her phone constantly but has no time for apps with learning curves.
Chidi — freelance plumber, Abuja	Gets jobs through word of mouth. Struggles to follow up on unpaid work. Wants a simple way to send a receipt that makes him look trustworthy and serious.
Ngozi — home caterer, Port Harcourt	Takes orders for events. Manages client expectations manually. Wants a professional page clients can share when recommending her.
Bello — fashion designer, Kano	Works with repeat clients. Wants to build a portfolio and reputation over time. Needs something that works well on a mid-range Android phone.

4.2 Secondary user — the client

The end client is a Nigerian consumer or business who hires the small business owner. They receive the Kova-generated page via WhatsApp link. They do not need an account. Their experience of Kova is passive but powerful — they see a professional page, pay easily, leave a review, and discover the platform.

5. Core features — MVP

5.1 Feature overview

Feature	Priority	User value	Anti-abandonment role
One-time business profile setup	P0 — must have	Sets brand identity forever	Sunk cost — they invested in setup
WhatsApp-triggered invoice creation	P0 — must have	Sends invoice in under 30 sec	Zero new habit — fits existing flow
Branded client page (job summary + invoice)	P0 — must have	Client gets premium experience	Clients talk about it, word spreads
Payment link on client page	P0 — must have	Business owner gets paid faster	Direct financial value, instant proof
Client open notification	P0 — must have	Owner knows when client viewed page	Dopamine hit — brings them back
One-tap review request	P1 — important	Builds reputation over time	Reviews accumulate — leaving = losing them
Business dashboard	P1 — important	Track invoices, payments, clients	Data lock-in — their history lives here
Auto-generated logo badge	P1 — important	No logo? We make one automatically	Zero barrier to first use
Client history and records	P2 — nice to have	Full client relationship log	Deep lock-in over time
Payment tracking and reminders	P2 — nice to have	Chase unpaid invoices automatically	Financial value compounds

New Retention Features

- Weekly earnings summary
- Monthly performance snapshot
- Smart payment reminders (“Send reminder?”)
- Manual payment confirmation
- Status badges (“Top Rated”, “Trusted by X clients”)
- Progress tracking (earnings, clients, reviews)

5.2 Feature details

F1 — Business profile setup (one time)

- Business owner uploads logo or types business name
- Platform auto-generates an initials badge if no logo is provided
- Owner adds phone number, location, and bank account for payment
- Owner selects a brand colour from 12 pre-set options
- All future invoices and client pages automatically use these brand assets
- Estimated setup time: under 5 minutes

F2 — WhatsApp-triggered invoice flow

- Business owner messages the Kova WhatsApp bot after completing a job
- Bot prompts: client name, service(s), and total amount — three fields maximum
- Platform generates a branded client page instantly
- A WhatsApp message is automatically drafted for the owner to send to their client
- Owner sends with one tap — no login, no app switching required
- Invoice number is auto-assigned and logged
- Contextual Templates: After the bot generates an invoice, provide the owner with 3 selectable message templates (e.g., Warm, Formal, Direct) to copy and send.
- Brand Voice Alignment: Use the "Brand Colour" and "Business Name" to auto-fill these templates so they feel bespoke and agency-grade.

F3 — Branded client page

- Business logo or badge, business name, and contact details in header
- Auto-generated invoice number and date
- Client name and contact
- Itemised job summary with individual line amounts and total
- Job status (completed / in progress)
- Payment status (paid / unpaid)
- Payment button linked to owner's preferred payment method
- One-tap review button
- Powered by Kova footer — organic discovery channel

F4 — Client open notification

- When a client opens the page, the business owner receives an instant WhatsApp notification
- Notification format: 'Tunde just opened your invoice — INV-047, ₦9,500'
- If payment is made: 'Payment received — ₦9,500 from Tunde. INV-047 is now paid'
- This single feature is the primary retention mechanism — it brings owners back every time

F5 — Business dashboard

- Accessible via web app (mobile-optimised) — not required for core invoice flow
- Overview: total invoices sent, total paid, outstanding balance, total clients
- Full client list with history per client
- Invoice log with status (sent / opened / paid / overdue)
- Review summary and rating display
- Dashboard becomes more valuable the longer a business uses Kova — compounding retention

F5 — Handling I have paid friction

- The "Proof of Payment" (PoP) Bridge: Add an optional "Attach Receipt" button to the Client Page after a user taps "I've Paid".
- Verification Workflow: WhatsApp notifications for owners will include a "Review Receipt" link and a "Mark as Paid" quick-action button.
- Multi-State Tracking: Implement a "Payment Claimed" status between "Unpaid" and "Paid" to manage expectations while the owner verifies the bank credit.

6. Key user flows

WhatsApp-Based Onboarding

Instead of traditional onboarding:

Kova sends:

- “Let’s set up your business in 2 minutes”
- “Send your first invoice now”
- “You just looked premium 🖐️”

→ Goal: First value in under 3 minutes

6.1 Business owner — first-time setup

1. Owner discovers Kova (via referral, 'powered by Kova' link, or marketing)
2. Opens Kova web app or scans WhatsApp QR code
3. Enters business name (or uploads logo)
4. Selects brand colour
5. Adds phone, location, and payment details
6. Profile saved — they are ready to send their first invoice
7. Platform sends a WhatsApp confirmation with their Kova bot number saved

6.2 Business owner — sending an invoice

8. Job is complete — owner opens WhatsApp and messages their Kova bot number
9. Bot responds: 'Who is this invoice for?' — owner replies with client name or number
10. Bot: 'What service(s) did you provide?' — owner types or selects from recent items
11. Bot: 'What is the total amount?' — owner types amount
12. Bot generates the invoice and sends back a preview with a sharable link
13. Owner taps to forward the link to their client on WhatsApp
14. Entire flow: under 30 seconds

6.3 Client — receiving and paying

15. Client receives a WhatsApp message from the business owner with a Kova link
16. Client opens link — sees a clean, branded invoice page
17. Client reviews the job summary and total amount
18. Client taps the pay button and completes payment via their preferred method
19. Client receives payment confirmation on the page
20. Client sees the one-tap review option — submits a rating if satisfied
21. Client notices 'powered by Kova' and may explore the platform

7. Technical requirements

7.1 Performance requirements

- Client page must load in under 2 seconds on a 3G connection
- WhatsApp bot must respond within 3 seconds of owner message
- Invoice page generation must complete within 5 seconds end to end
- Platform must support concurrent usage across all major Nigerian mobile networks
- App must function on Android devices running Android 8.0 and above
- Any logo uploaded during setup must be auto-optimized to **WebP format** for low-spec device compatibility.

7.2 Architecture overview

Component	Approach
Frontend — business dashboard	Progressive Web App (PWA) — mobile-optimised, installable, works offline for viewing
Client invoice page	Server-side rendered static page — ultra-fast load, no JavaScript required to view
WhatsApp integration	WhatsApp Business API via approved provider (e.g. Twilio, Termii, or Zoko)
Database	PostgreSQL — business profiles, invoices, clients, payments, reviews
File storage	Cloud storage (e.g. AWS S3) for logos and brand assets
Notifications	WhatsApp Business API for real-time client open and payment notifications
Hosting	Cloud-based with Nigerian CDN nodes to optimise for local network performance

7.3 Security and compliance

- All client data encrypted in transit (TLS 1.3) and at rest
- Business owners authenticate via phone number OTP — no password required
- Payment processing delegated entire — No financial liability for Kova
- Client invoice pages are accessible only via unique, non-guessable URL tokens
- NDPA (Nigeria Data Protection Act) compliance for all user data handling

8. Brand identity

8.1 Brand overview

Brand element	Definition
Name	Kova
Tagline	Your business, seen properly.
Primary colour	#1A1060 — Kova Navy
Accent colour	#7F77DD — Kova Purple
Background tint	#EEEDFE — Kova Mist
Success colour	#1D9E75 — Kova Green (used only for paid / live states)
Logo mark	Three-stroke K — spine plus two arms in different weights, representing business owner and client both connected
Typography	Arial — universally supported, professional, accessible
Brand voice	Confident, warm, straight-talking. Never corporate, never complicated.

8.2 Brand values

- Dignity — every small business deserves to be taken seriously
- Simplicity — if it is not effortless, it is not Kova
- Trust — every interaction must make the client feel safe and the owner look credible
- Speed — time is the most valuable resource for a small business owner

9. Go-to-market strategy

9.1 Distribution model

Kova is a B2B2C product. The business owner is the buyer. The client is the organic distribution channel. Every invoice sent to a client is a Kova advertisement — the 'powered by Kova' link at the bottom of every page drives discovery from clients who then become business owners on the platform.

9.2 Launch phases

Phase	Strategy
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Phase 1 — Seed (Month 1–2)	Manual onboarding of 50 businesses in Lagos across beauty, food, and home services. Daily feedback. Fix what breaks. Build the WhatsApp bot to be robust before scaling.
Phase 2 — Grow (Month 3–4)	Open sign-ups. Referral programme — existing businesses get 1 free month for every business they refer. Target trade associations, market groups, and local business WhatsApp communities.
Phase 3 — Scale (Month 5+)	Paid marketing on WhatsApp status, Instagram, and Google. Expand to Abuja, Port Harcourt, Kano. Introduce premium tier with advanced analytics and custom domain invoice pages.

9.3 Pricing model

Tier	Details
Free — forever	Up to 20 invoices per month. Kova branding on all pages. Basic dashboard. Unlimited clients. WhatsApp bot access.
Pro — ₦3,500/month	Unlimited invoices. Remove Kova branding. Custom brand colour per invoice. Advanced dashboard with payment analytics. Priority notification delivery.
Business — ₦8,000/month	Everything in Pro. Custom invoice page domain (e.g. invoice.kemisalon.com). Client portal with full job history visible to repeat clients. Monthly business summary report.

9.4 Monetization Strategy

Kova's monetization is built on a value-first principle:

Users only pay when they are clearly making money or gaining visible business advantage.

The platform follows a **progressive monetization model**:

- **Free tier** drives adoption and habit formation
- **Paid tiers (Pro, Business)** unlock features tied to revenue growth, branding, and insights

This positions Kova as a **revenue enabler, not a cost**.

Future monetization layers include:

- **Optional payment convenience features** (for instant confirmation, on a per-use basis)
- **Advanced analytics and growth tools** for scaling businesses
- **Premium visibility and trust signals** (e.g., verified badges, top-rated status)

Pricing will continuously evolve based on **user earnings, usage patterns, and retention behavior**, ensuring accessibility within the Nigerian market.

1. Retention-First Product Strategy

Core Principle

If Kova does not:

- Help users make money
- Show visible progress
- Reward usage emotionally

It will be abandoned.

Retention Loops

Revenue Loop

1. Send invoice
2. Client opens
3. Client pays
4. Owner gets confirmation
5. Owner sees earnings

→ Reinforces financial value

Dopamine Loop

- “Client opened your invoice 🧾”
- “Payment received ~~TX~~ 💰”
- “You earned ~~TX~~ this week 🔥”

→ Emotional engagement

Reputation Loop

- Client leaves review
- Rating increases
- Business gains status

→ Builds switching cost

Follow-up Loop

- Unpaid invoice detected
- Smart reminder triggered
- Payment completed

→ Drives repeat usage

2. Anti-Abandonment Architecture

First 7-Day Activation Targets

Within first 7 days, user must:

- Send 3 invoices
- Receive 1 payment
- Get 1 review

→ If achieved = high retention probability

Lock-in Mechanisms

Data Lock-in

- Invoice history
- Client records

Reputation Lock-in

- Reviews
- Ratings

Financial Lock-in

- Earnings tracking

3. Payment Strategy Upgrade

Kova does not process or hold payments.

Instead, Kova enables direct payment between client and business owner using familiar local methods.

Payment Flow:

- Business owner adds bank or wallet details during setup (Nigeria banks)
- Client views payment details on invoice page
- Client completes transfer externally
- Client taps “I’ve paid”
- Business owner confirms and marks invoice as paid

Key Principles:

- Zero onboarding friction
- Align with Nigerian payment behavior
- No third-party dependency
- No financial liability for Kova

Risk Control:

To prevent false payment claims:

- Payments are only marked as complete after owner confirmation
- Payment status includes: Pending, Payment Claimed, and Paid
- Notifications clearly indicate when a client *claims* to have paid

10. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
WhatsApp Business API access delays or policy changes	Medium	High	Build web app fallback invoice creation flow alongside the bot from day one
Business owners abandon after first use	Medium	High	Instant first-use value, Real-time notifications, Revenue feedback, Payment reminders, Reputation system, Weekly engagement nudges

10.1 Extended Risk Handling Framework

Kova operates in a trust-sensitive market where risks extend beyond technical security into payment trust, identity integrity, and platform misuse.

To mitigate payment-related risks, Kova introduces a **“Payment Claimed” state** supported by optional **payment reference capture** and quick verification actions for business owners. Payments are only confirmed after owner validation, ensuring clarity without introducing friction.

To prevent abuse, all accounts are tied to **OTP-verified phone numbers**, with activity monitoring, rate limits, and anomaly detection applied to identify suspicious behavior. Over time, Kova will develop a **trust scoring system** to strengthen platform integrity.

To reduce dependency on external platforms, Kova maintains a **web-based fallback flow** for invoice creation and access, ensuring continuity beyond WhatsApp constraints.

Finally, all reviews are **invoice-linked and transaction-bound**, preventing manipulation and preserving the credibility of the platform’s reputation system.

11. Product roadmap

Phase	Timeframe	Focus	Key deliverables
Alpha	Month 1	Internal build and test	WhatsApp bot, invoice generation, branded client page, payment link, open notification

Beta	Month 2	50 real business pilots	Business dashboard, review system, auto logo badge.
v1.0 Launch	Month 3	Public release, Lagos	Full free tier, Pro tier, referral programme, onboarding flow
v1.1	Month 4–5	Retention and growth	Client history portal, payment reminders, invoice templates, business analytics
v2.0	Month 6+	Scale and expand	Custom domains, multi-city expansion, English West Africa rollout, team accounts for SMBs

12. Open questions

- Should Kova eventually offer its own payment processing, or remain a connector to existing payment providers?
- At what point does the client-facing experience get a dedicated app — or does it remain link-only permanently?
- How do we handle businesses in industries with compliance requirements (e.g. legal, medical)?
- Should the free tier include the 'powered by Kova' link as a hard requirement, or make it optional from day one to accelerate trust?
- What is the right moment to expand beyond Nigeria — and should West Africa or the UK diaspora market come first?

13. Appendix

13.1 Glossary

Term	Definition
Kova bot	The WhatsApp Business API chatbot through which business owners trigger invoice creation
Client page	The branded, shareable web page that the client receives containing the job summary, invoice, and payment link
Business profile	The one-time setup that stores a business owner's brand assets, contact details, and payment information
Invoice	A record of a completed job including line items, totals, client details, and payment status

Open notification	The WhatsApp alert sent to a business owner the moment their client views the client page
Powered by Kova	The attribution link at the bottom of every client page that drives organic platform discovery
PWA	Progressive Web App — a web application that can be installed on a phone's home screen and works offline
P0 / P1 / P2	Priority levels: P0 = must have for launch; P1 = important but not blocking; P2 = future consideration

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